



PHOTO BY MANDAR DEODHAR

DREAM MACHINES Abhishek Agarwal likes cars that combine performance with luxury

LUXURY ON WHEELS

Abhishek Agarwal, Founder of Purple Style Labs, loves everything luxury, whether it's fashion or cars

BY **SMITA TRIPATHI**

A **BHISHEK AGARWAL, THE** 33-year-old Founder of Purple Style Labs—which owns luxury fashion stores Pernia's Pop-Up and Wendell Rodricks—is not your typical IITian. “The thing about IITians is that they are all very similar. But I did not enter IIT like a typical IITian. Belonging to a business family from a small town, I spent my teenage years shopping and dressing up. I just happened to land in IIT,” laughs the IIT Bombay alumnus.

Agarwal has always been passionate about two things—fashion and cars. While he made one his calling, the other is his love. “I didn’t want to buy just any car. I was willing to wait, as long as my first car was one I really wanted,” says Agarwal. So, while most start-up entrepreneurs purchase a mid-level sedan or SUV as their first car, Agarwal bought the Mercedes-Maybach S-Class S 680 in March last year. “I set up my company in 2015 and waited seven years, traveling around in a rented Innova, till I had the means to buy the Maybach,” he says. While he booked the car in March, he only got delivery of it in December. So in July of last year, he bought the Maserati Levante. “I am not much of a sports